Knowledge organiser for the bus boycott

Friday 15 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | GROW | Spring 1 Week 2 | HUM-GROW-S1-W02

Learning outcome: Use sources to investigate a campaign for rights and change.

Enquiry: What helped the campaign change bus rights?

In Montgomery, Alabama, USA, racist bus rules kept Black and White riders apart. Black residents had challenged these rules for years. Rosa Parks was arrested on 1 December 1955 after refusing to give up her seat. The bus boycott began on 5 December. Many people worked together to seek change.

Date	Event
5 December 1955	The boycott starts. People stop using buses as a protest.
5 June 1956	Federal judges rule against bus segregation in Browder v. Gayle.
13 November 1956	The US Supreme Court upholds the ruling.
20 December 1956	The court order arrives. The MIA ends the boycott.
21 December 1956	People return to buses with the old seating rule removed.

Use sources with care

People's protest, shared rides, funds and a legal case all mattered. One person did not do it alone. Bus rights changed; racism did not end.

A leaflet shows a call to act. A court decision shows a legal ruling. A short history can bring facts together. None can tell us everything.

MIA means Montgomery Improvement Association. It helped lead the boycott.

Where this leads: museum and archive staff check sources before making a claim.

These five cards are new teaching summaries. The lesson writer made them in 2026. No old text or picture is copied. The record or history behind each card has its own maker and purpose.